Axon VR Adoption: Q3 2025 Report

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Document Purpose: These reports are designed to serve as a barometer for VR adoption across our customer base. They will highlight key adoption trends, surface challenges still limiting impact, outline current initiatives addressing those gaps, and identify future opportunities to accelerate VR's path to ubiquity and contribute to TASER weapons' life-saving effectiveness.

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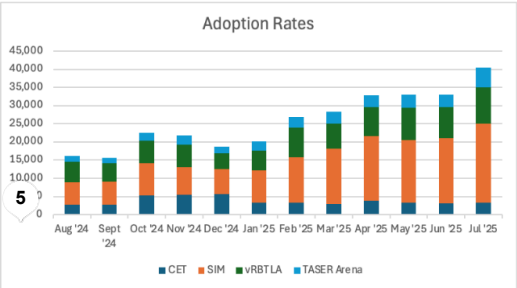
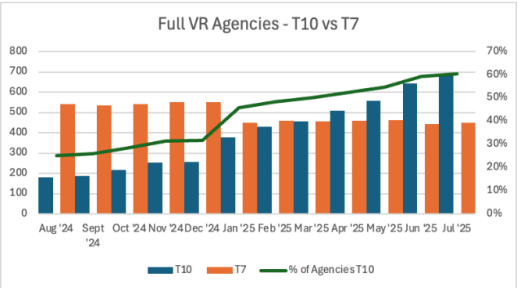
Adoption Update

OVERVIEW





Over the past year we have seen significant growth in use across every one of our products, resulting in **a 150% increase in aggregate product use** since August 2024. The products seeing the most growth are Simulator Training (+209% YoY) and

TASER Arena (+168% YoY). This growth can primarily be attributed to a larger customer base (1141 agencies, +58% YoY), as well as a higher penetration rate of active customers each month (40% of agencies, +20% YoY); use per active agency in a month remains relatively flat (average 92 trainings, +6% YoY).

We have also seen a significant spike in T10 agencies since the end of last year, with 60% of our Simulator customers having a T10 as of July '25 (as compared to 32% at EOY). **T10 customers are completing 2.4x more trainings than our T7 customers**, presumably due to the drastic need (and subsequent organizational emphasis) for more training on this newer TASER platform. It's important to note there currently are no requirements or recommendations for T7 agencies to train with VR during their CEW Certifications. This shift in customer composition is therefore also contributing to growth across our products.

Major Agencies (≥500 sworn) continue to drive a disproportionate share of VR engagement: while they represent fewer than 10% of all customers (94 agencies), they account for over 60% of all recorded training sessions in 2025. These agencies typically maintain steady monthly usage, especially those engaged with more than one content type.

	A	B	C	D	E
1	**Top VR Agencies**	**Agency Size**	**All Product Completions (T12 Months)**	**Trainings Per Person**	**# of Active Months (12)**
2	**Baltimore City Police Dept - MD**	2836	14,938	5.3	12
3	**Baltimore County Police Dept. - MD**	2194	7,654	3.5	6
4	**Albuquerque Police Dept. - NM**	1335	6,212	4.7	7
5	**Charlotte - Mecklenburg Police Dept. - NC**	2010	6,064	3.0	12
6	**Metro Nashville Police Department -TN**	1400	4,810	3.4	12
7	**Palm Beach County Sheriff's Office - FL**	2000	4,164	2.1	10
8	**Maryland State Police - MD**	2325	3,906	1.7	5
9	**Oklahoma City Police Dept. - OK**	1458	3,845	2.6	12
10	**San Bernardino County Sheriff's Dept. - CA**	950	3,316	3.5	8
11	**Pittsburgh Bureau of Police - PA**	992	2,857	2.9	12

For a deeper dive into each product's specific adoption, see Product Adoption in the Appendix.
For a deeper dive into APAP as a measure of our product adoption, see APAP in the Appendix.

T10 - VR ADOPTION RATES

In 2025, we've prioritized improving the onboarding of net-new TASER 10 + VR Major Agencies, ensuring each is set up to incorporate VR into their **initial CEW trainings — the primary entry point for VR within an agency's training program**. A new workflow across PSO and CSM teams now tracks each agency's next CEW training date and triggers proactive support to drive timely VR integration. So far, five Major Agencies have gone through this new onboarding flow since its introduction in April, with positive feedback from customers, PSMs, and CSMs. Notably, Arizona DOC is the first to have begun their CEW training, and successfully integrated VR into it as a result of these efforts. While this workflow has been limited to T10 Major Accounts who have purchased VR over the last 6 months, we are planning to expand it to new customers across all line sizes by the end of the year. (*For more details on this workflow, see New T10-VR Major Accounts M&M in the Appendix.)*

Though the onboarding workflow is still maturing, PSO has been leading program development sessions during onsite visits since 1/1/2024, and these have become a core part of our onboarding strategy. These sessions help agencies define clear VR training goals and build structured programs to achieve them. Even without the downstream CSM workflow, the impact is clear: **agencies that receive PSO-led program development complete 6x more trainings** than those without it—highlighting the importance of in-person PSO services compared to virtual or no onboarding.

Despite these operational improvements, **only 39.5% of T10 agencies** are averaging 1 SIM training per officer over the past 12 months (a baseline indicator of VR being integrated into annual CEW certification). While T10 agencies remain **2x more**

likely than T7 agencies to hit this threshold, there's still meaningful opportunity to **reduce integration friction** and help more agencies embed VR into their core training workflows. We will explore these more in Adoption Opportunities below.

Adoption Insights and Takeaways

TREND INSIGHTS ON VR EFFECTIVENESS (NOAH BURBANK)

Preliminary quantitative analysis of VR telemetry data reveals what we call the The VR Inoculation Model: The T10 Playbook V2 - VR training (and training in general) functions as an inoculation against ineffectiveness. An intervention with Austin PD show that effectiveness declines post training, and that putting all their officers through VR boosted their effectiveness - although temporarily, as these skills are perishable and constantly need refreshing. We are planning future work to quantify how much and how frequently (the dosage and schedule) agencies should do VR training to keep their effectiveness in an acceptable range.

The process of building the T10 Playbook is not done yet. We will continue to expand TREND to more agencies so that our data better represents the diversity of the 18,000 law enforcement agencies in the United States. We have a project underway to improve our agency data so that we can better separate the high and low performing agencies. We have another to add guardrails to data entry in TREND so we get higher quality data, ensuring that every form entered is actually another data point. More ethnographic interviews across a greater diversity of agencies will deepen our understanding of users feelings and perceptions. Identified logistical issues (VR has logistical hassles: The T10 Playbook V2) will be unified with insights gathered across the VR team for a playbook of corrective actions.

MAJOR VS. SMALLER AGENCY ADOPTION TRENDS

Major Agencies continue to lead in total VR training volume, accounting for **over 60% of all sessions** in the past year. But this volume is also shaped by structural constraints: these agencies operate on long planning cycles, often 12+ months in advance, and must standardize training across large, distributed workforces. Even top performers like Baltimore City PD and Charlotte-Mecklenburg PD — with over 14,000 and 4,500 completions, respectively — face long rollouts when deploying new content. For Majors, adoption tends to grow steadily, not in bursts, and success depends on aligning with their operational rhythms. They are high-volume, but also high-friction customers.

In contrast, smaller agencies (<500 sworn) often engage in short, SIM-centric bursts, typically lasting just 1–2 months before going dormant. Their **usage tends to cluster around TASER recertification windows** or new content launches. While Majors sustain long-term usage across more content types, smaller agencies require proactive outreach to stay engaged, especially as the offering rapidly grows.

Interestingly, while Major Agencies are 3x less likely to meet adoption thresholds like APAP — due to the inherent complexity of scaling VR — Majors that do adopt are doing so faster: 5% faster than small agencies and 17% faster than mid-size agencies. This acceleration is likely the result of our onboarding improvements under the New T10-VR Major Accounts M&M, including better PSO services and stronger CSM handoffs to support early integration of VR into CEW rollouts. More broadly, **initial adoption speed is improving across all agency sizes**, likely driven by both product enhancements (e.g., content volume, UX improvements) and VR's elevated role in Version 24 CEW training (*see VR Integration at MIS + TIS in the Appendix for more information*).

Multi-program adoption is also a key differentiator. Among Majors using SIM, 62% also use CET or vRBT-LA, compared to just 21% of smaller agencies. This matters: agencies using more than one product are 2.5x more likely to stay active across multiple quarters. In contrast, single-product users — especially in the small-to-mid range — often lapse quickly without intentional re-engagement.

We also see a **repeatable pattern in content discovery:** agencies typically begin with SIM, then explore CET 1–2 months

later, if at all. For smaller agencies in particular, this discovery often stalls. They may lack visibility into broader content or not run programs (e.g., Behavioral Health, Recruit Academies) where CET or vRBT-LA would naturally fit. Others rely on regional academies for specialty training, further fragmenting their usage of the full VR suite.

Finally, **this Spring brought a notable wave of re-engagement**, particularly in March and April, driven by new SIM content — including the TASER Validation Courses, vRBT Solo Mode, and Scenario Configuration. Many of these reactivations came from previously high-SIM users, underscoring the value of **content-based re-engagement** and the impact of **multi-product exposure** on retention.

OFFLINE PRODUCT USAGE

Contrary to earlier assumptions, most VR training activity occurs online: ~85% of training events are captured within a month of activity, and only 15% arrive later due to offline sync delays. Analysis of 933 agencies shows that 83% are “mostly online”, with just 2% operating “mostly offline.” Offline mode is primarily used for remedial training or specific logistical needs (e.g., field evals or remote locations), and true hybrid users make up only 15% of the install base. We’ve identified a cohort of 30 agencies with varying online/offline behavior to support future VOC efforts if further evaluation of offline needs is required. (*For more information, see Online vs Offline use of Simulator Training.*)

While most training sessions are conducted online, the **majority of customer devices remain offline**. Of 18,000 devices, only 35% have come online in the past two months, and just 11% have received the latest SIM update (launched 8/5). Yet, 66% of agencies logged at least one training during that time, suggesting that agencies are **relying on a limited subset of their fleet** and reusing the same headsets for most sessions.

Though further research and VOC is needed, early feedback suggests this is due to logistical challenges — many trainers can only set up and manage a small number of headsets during annual training events, limiting broader device utilization and consequently concurrent training sessions.

Adoption Opportunities

CUSTOMER ADOPTION JOURNEY

Axon VR’s long-term vision is to become a comprehensive learning platform that accelerates skill development and mitigates skill fade through decentralized training. While the offering has expanded to support new programs (e.g., Crisis Intervention, Specialized Tactics) and modalities (e.g., micro-training), our **core use case remains Annual CEW Certifications**. Outside of a few large agencies (e.g., Baltimore City PD), agencies that don’t first adopt VR for CEW training rarely go on to build successful VR programs.

To guide adoption and align our roadmap, we’ve defined a three-phase progression —

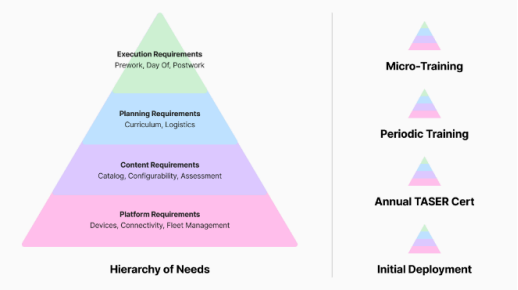
PHASE 1 - Annual CEW Training

PHASE 2 - CEW Micro-Training

PHASE 3 - Other In-Service Training

Despite this focus, less than 34% of agencies are currently completing Phase 1 (measured as at least 1 SIM training per officer annually). And while some forward-leaning agencies (e.g., Lincoln PD) have begun experimenting with Phase 2, micro-training remains difficult to scale with the current product experience.
While agency pain points vary depending on the Phase / training use case, generally these pain points tend to fall into five stages of a typical VR training workflow:

Our UX and Research teams are mapping the customer journey across these stages, connecting hierarchy of needs (Platform, Content, Planning, Execution) to various training program types (e.g., Deployment, Annual Cert, Micro-Training). This effort aims to surface lower-layer blockers (e.g., connectivity, updates, pairing) and inform a prioritized product roadmap.



We expect initial findings in time to support ZBB resourcing. In parallel, multiple initiatives are already underway to address known issues across the five training stages and three adoption phases.

PHASE 1 - Annual CEW Certification

BUILDING A CURRICULUM

VR Sidekick GPT for Customer-Facing Teams (Jay Silvas)
Problem: CSMs struggle to quickly access up-to-date VR training guidance, product updates, and engagement strategies due to static playbooks and scattered documentation.
Solution: Launching an AI-powered assistant to centralize VR knowledge and deliver real-time, scenario-based support. This tool will improve CSM enablement, support tailored customer recommendations, and drive VR adoption.
Milestones: Pilot launch targeted for 8/29; expansion planned throughout Q4 to support ongoing product evolution and broader use.

FACILITATING A TRAINING

Custom Playlists (@Sophi Kim)
Problem: Trainees—especially during annual CEW trainings—struggle to navigate VR menus, leading to frequent user errors and delays. With limited trainer support and multiple officers training simultaneously, these issues compound and reduce training throughput.
Solution: Introduce trainer-configured Custom Playlists that lock in a predefined training sequence across all headsets, streamlining the trainee experience and reducing in-headset confusion.
Milestones: Currently in ideation phase, targeting a **2026 release**. Early customer feedback suggests this feature could **double training efficiency** during group sessions.

PHASE 2 - CEW Micro-Training

BUILDING A CURRICULUM

Micro-Training Playbook (@Chloe Preble)
Problem: Agencies face fragmented support, tech confusion, and unclear ownership when trying to scale decentralized (micro) VR training, leading to inconsistent implementation and stalled adoption.
Solution: Develop a modular, field-ready Micro-Training Playbook that consolidates best practices for onboarding, role continuity, internal buy-in, and long-term sustainability.
Milestones: Current draft under internal review with Training and PSO; customer testing planned to validate usability. An interactive version tailored by agency profile is being scoped for **2026**.

SETTING UP A TRAINING

CMS Web UI (Sophi Kim)
Problem: Only CET currently allows admins to manage offline content while in-headset, but total content across all apps exceeds headset storage limits, creating usability and deployment challenges especially with large-scale deployments.
Solution: Build a CMS Web UI that enables trainers to selectively download and manage offline content across all VR applications.
Milestones: Foundational CMS 2.0 work is in progress; SKU-CMS and Web UI rollout targeted for **2026**.

FACILITATING A TRAINING

Agency and User-Specific "Sticky" Settings (Sophi Kim)
Problem: Current settings are saved per device, causing friction when different users have conflicting preferences (e.g., handedness) and creating risk when trainees inadvertently alter agency-wide settings.
Solution: Enable persistent, role-specific settings—trainers can lock agency-wide defaults, while users can save personal preferences across sessions, improving setup efficiency and reducing error.
Milestones: Feature is slated for **2026** ZBB; no active development underway.

Improving Real-Time Feedback UI to Improve Solo / Micro-Training Outcomes (Lakshmanan Palani)
Problem: Solo and micro-training sessions are hindered by confusing or overloaded in-headset feedback, making it difficult for officers to train effectively without live support.
Solution: Redesign the Real-Time Feedback System to deliver prioritized, intuitive guidance through ambient cues (voice, light), clearer hit indicators, synchronized threat signals, and a persistent, hierarchical UI.
Milestones**:** Updates rolling out in phases throughout **Q4/Q1,** with these enhancements supporting better self-directed training, scalable kiosk deployment, and laying groundwork for future AI-driven coaching and AAR features. Real Time Feedback System: One Pager

DOCUMENTING A TRAINING

User Identification in Headset (@Sophi Kim)
Problem: Previously, SIM training data could only be logged through 1:1 trainer-led sessions using a tablet, limiting scalability beyond remedial training scenarios.
Solution: Introduced in-headset user identification via personalized QR codes, allowing trainees to self-sign in and have their completions automatically logged to their profile in the Web App AAR.
Milestones: Launched in **SIM on 8/5/25**; expansion to additional applications is actively in progress.

PHASE 3 - Other In-Service Trainings

BUILDING A CURRICULUM

VR Content Selection GPT (Wenmei Hill / Emilee Daley)
Problem: As the VR library grows, internal teams and trainers face challenges identifying content aligned to specific training goals.
Solution: Developed a GPT-powered content assistant trained on Axon VR content metadata, facilitator guides, scripts, and learning objectives to return relevant modules based on user queries.
Milestones: Internal launch to CSM and PSO teams set for 8/30/25. A customer-facing version is under consideration pending internal adoption and feedback.

Scaling VR Instructor Training Beyond PSO Deployments (Christian Kardish)
Problem: As Axon VR evolves, relying solely on one-time, in-person PSO deployments for trainer enablement is no longer scalable. Trainers lack ongoing support, creating challenges with product re-engagement, especially when usage is infrequent or when key instructors leave.
Solution: Explore scalable alternatives to maintain trainer readiness throughout the contract lifecycle — including virtual check-ins, integration with agency training infrastructure, and potential VR certification pathways.
Milestones: Strategy outlined in One Pager: Scaling Product Onboarding Across the Contract Lifecycle; next steps focused on evaluating delivery models and resource impact.

What's Next

While adoption is up year-over-year—driven by growth in newer accounts and improvements in onboarding—the majority of agencies still **aren't consistently using VR for Annual CEW Certifications**, our core use case. This remains the clearest leading indicator of long-term program success, and must remain the highest priority for product and operational focus.

We now have two strategic frameworks to guide what we build next:

- A **training-phase model** (CEW Cert → Micro-Training → In-Service) that helps clarify where our customers are and what training experiences to prioritize.
- A **training workflow model** (Curriculum → Setup → Facilitation → Coaching → Documentation) that categorizes where pain points occur and what capabilities we need to unlock adoption.

Next steps include:

- Completing the mapping of known and emerging pain points to these frameworks as part of the **UXR-led Customer Journey Mapping**.
- Running **cross-functional workshops at the 9/3 Offsite** to align on which solutions should be prioritized for 2026 ZBB planning.
- Finalizing a third supporting framework that maps Axon's product and content strategy to an **officer's training journey**,

aligning feature-sets and product scope with specific learning moments.

- Synthesizing findings and opportunities into a new APAP threshold that more properly measures adoption across all line sizes and phases of adoption.

Together, these efforts will ensure we're solving the right problems, in the right order, to close today's adoption gaps—and ultimately scale Axon VR's impact across more training types and more agencies.

Appendix

Appendix
Updates on Company Goals
Product Adoption
Framework to Increase Adoption

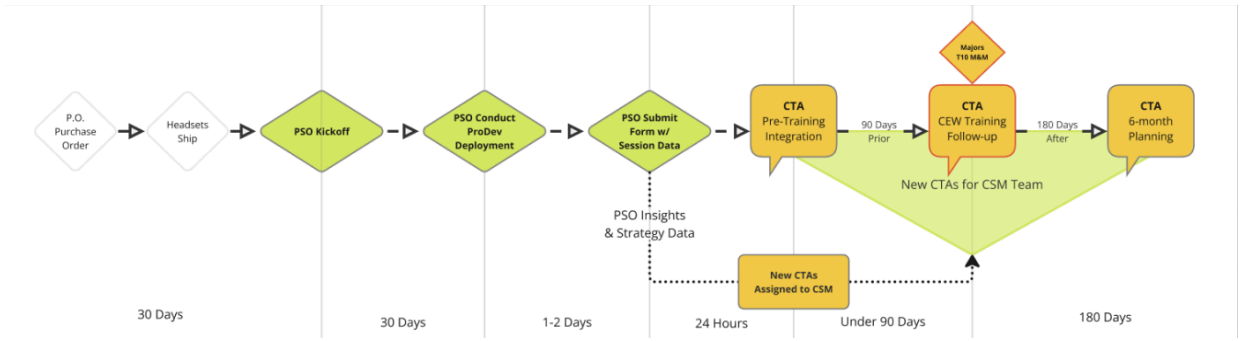
Updates on Company Goals

NEW T10-VR MAJOR ACCOUNTS M&M

What: From 4/1/25 onwards, ensure that 75% of Major agencies (>= 550 sworn) that purchase VR and T10 choose to make VR training an inherent part of their T10 rollout to their officers.
Why: This initiative is to help ensure that new customers are incorporating VR into their initial T10 certifications given that it is the best opportunity for an agency to recognize the value of VR and build off of it moving forward.

Status: We are trending Green to reaching our end of year goal of at least 75% of new accounts using VR in their initial CEW rollout. Reporting on eligible T10 Major Accounts is available here.

As a part of this initiative, we first setup a mechanism to (1) collect key training information from agencies during their PSO deployment, (2) digitize and make that information easily accessible to CSMs, (3) automate CTAs for CSMs to conduct outreach around key training milestones, and (4) track an agency's progress throughout their onboarding journey to measure our progress to our goal. This initiative involved a new Snowflake and Gainsight integration that brings important customer insights — like key training dates — directly to CSMs to help organize their outreach efforts, as well as a new Sigma dashboard to track all eligible customers along their onboarding process.



Since the M&M began on 4/1/2025, we now have 13 eligible agencies including 3 Corrections Agencies. Arizona DOC is the first eligible agency to have completed their PSO services (7/9), and will begin their CEW Training on 7/31 — the agency's CSM has confirmed our new CTA workflow in Gainsight is working as expected, which will help ensure that the agency is prepared to use VR as a part of their CEW Training. 5 other such agencies have their PSO onsites scheduled over the next 4 weeks, which we will continue to track closely with their assigned PSM and CSM.

We are also in the midst of expanding the M&M and aforementioned workflows to New Market agencies. Following the GA release of VR in the UK and AUS/NZ on 6/24, we've initiated efforts to expand the T10-VR M&M framework to International agencies over 550+ sworn. Since VR won't be available in the UK until T10 receives full approval, our current focus is on adapting the model for Australia. We're working closely with regional Training and CSM teams to align the process with local needs, while also partnering with Infosec to obtain the necessary approvals and ensure compliance with regional data requirements. For adjacent markets, Federal and Enterprise, we've communicated the M&M framework to regional leaders, but these efforts are currently on pause given the absence of major VR deals in those segments.

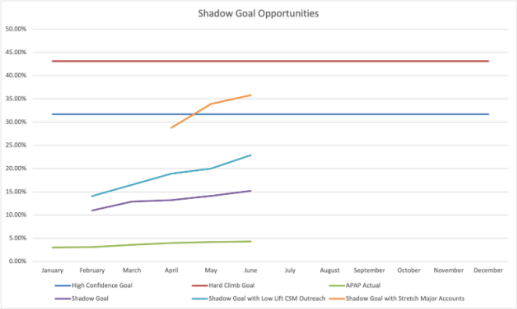
Lastly, we are working with the CSM organization to expand these workflows to T1200 agencies (100-550 sworn officers) despite being outside the scope of the M&M. See CSM VR SPIF Proposal H2 2025 for more information.

APAP

What: 1) Agency Simulator completion event count must be at least 1.5X their Axon Footprint Size over the previous 12 months AND 2) Agencies that have purchased Full VR have CET + vRBT LA + Verbal Training Scenarios completion event count must be at least 36 over the previous 6 months.
Why: This year's threshold is focused on driving customers towards incorporating Simulator Training into their annual TASER operator certifications as the first step in their adoption journey, while also ensuring they continue to use our other products throughout the year to encourage use beyond annual CEW training. This threshold should provide a solid foundation to expand VR into additional training programs, and increases the likelihood of an agency renewing their VR contract at the end of their 5-year term.

Status: We are Red and will not meet EOY goals, trailing by -2,740 bps to (High Confidence) and -3,880 bps (Hard Climb). VR's APAP miss is primarily attributed to agencies not meeting threshold #2 (non-SIM usage). Our separate 'Shadow Goal' which considers solely SIM-only use (threshold #1), we are at 15.2% (+50 bps MoM) across 229 agencies.

If we were to reach our High Confidence goal rate under either APAP or Shadow Goal thresholds, we would need significant adoption increases primarily from 23 major agencies to do so. While these 23 agencies have conducted at least 500 SIM trainings in the past 12 months — some having conducted thousands of trainings across all products in that time frame — these agencies still need on average 900 more SIM completions in the next 4 months to meet even our Shadow Goal's threshold. We have identified 77 agencies with higher likelihood of surpassing these thresholds, but they would only contribute +5.7 ppts and leave us still well short of our goal rates.



- *Example 1: Charlotte Mecklenburg PD has completed over 4,500 trainings across our products in the last year (2x their agency size), but would still need another 500 SIM completions to meet both our Shadow Goal and official APAP threshold.*
- *Example 2: Baltimore City PD has completed 14,500 trainings across our products in the last year (5x their agency size), but would still need another 2,450 SIM completions to meet both our Shadow Goal and official APAP threshold.*

Although we had originally aligned to start including VR APAP goals in 2H ’25 into CSM commissions, we are revisiting that approach given that our current APAP metric is not reflective of our priorities to: 1) focus on SIM vs. non-SIM usage, 2) T10 agencies vs. T7 agencies, and 3) ensuring net-new T10/VR customers use VR as part of their T10 rollout, with a secondary focus on existing customers continuing to use VR as part of annual T10 certification. We are discussing alternative incentive structures against these priorities with VR and CSM leadership, and will align on a new proposal by 8/30.

Monthly Writeups are available here — APAP 2025

VR INTEGRATION AT MIS + TIS

Owners: (Jason Spencer + Sam Orlov) - Axon VR SIM has been integrated into all MIS and TIS courses during 2025. During MIS the student completes approximately 8 hours of hands-on training across four days. For TIS Courses students get approximately 4 hours of instruction across two days. The “Why” is discussed as to the benefits of VR training in TASER applications, emphasizing targeting, behavior change, and real-world application.

The following topics are covered and demonstrated:

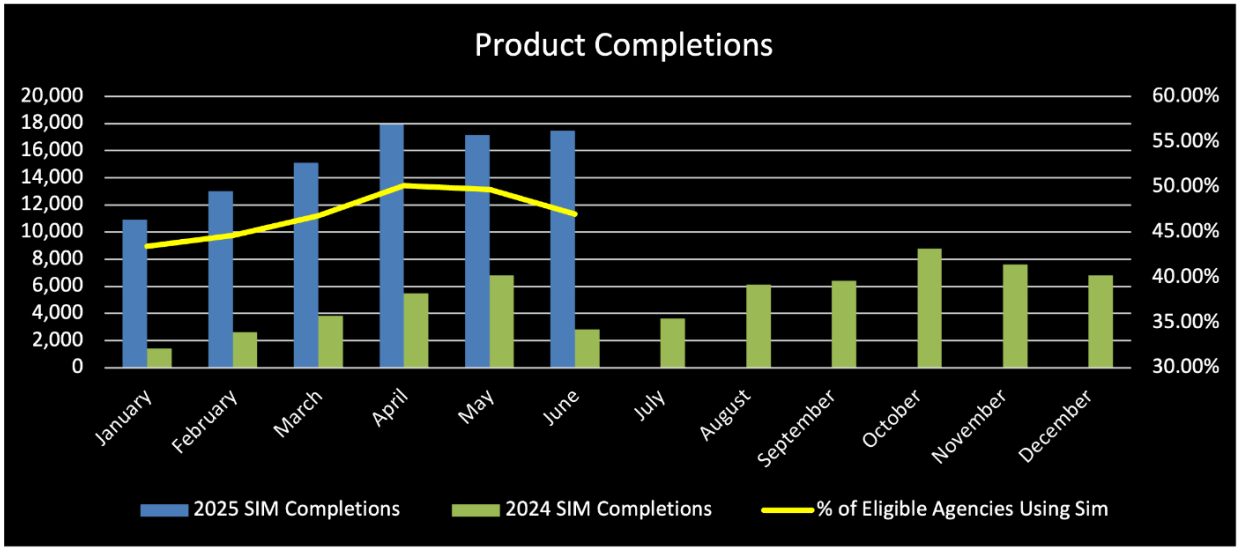
- Nomenclature
- Casting
- Pairing
- Troubleshooting
- Ranges (Distance, Clothing, Alternate Positions, Moving Targets, Broken Circuit, Re-Energize)
- Utilizing QR Codes
- Core I
- Core II
- Gauntlet

While the student is expected to pass Core I, Core II, and Gauntlet, the focus of the training is on how to instruct utilizing VR and being able to set up, troubleshoot, and navigate within VR Equipment for TASER Courses. The students are encouraged at the end of the training to explore the different menus and modules in headset to become as familiar as possible if time permits.

By the end of training most students understand the importance of VR integration into TASER Programs and are comfortable utilizing the VR equipment. Many students show an interest in obtaining VR in the future if they don’t already have it.

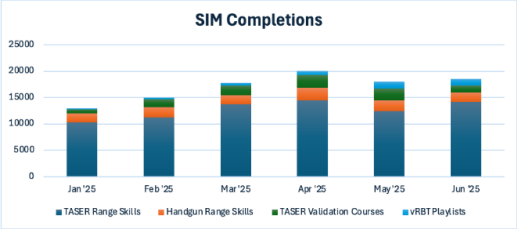
Product Adoption

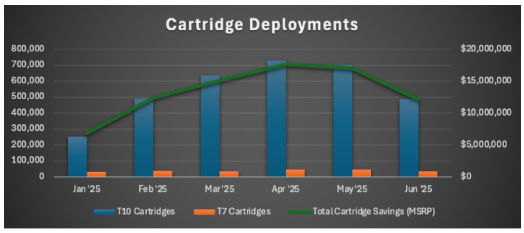
SIMULATOR TRAINING (JAMES HOLLOWAY + CHRISTIAN KARDISH)



Thru the 1st half of 2025, we have consistently been hitting new all-time highs in terms of single-month adoption of SIM. This is an encouraging trend despite training seasonality in the summer, proven by historical adoption trends — for context, June 2024 experienced a 56% drop MoM from May 2024.

We are also seeing relative consistency in the % of eligible agencies using the product this year — meaning the growth in SIM's aggregate usage is driven by both agencies using the product more (+9% MoM) and more customers onboarding (+5.9% MoM), versus solely the latter.





Despite the release and training emphasis on T10 Validation Courses thru the first half of this year, we have still seen steady growth in TASER Range Skills use, indicating the former has not cannibalized consumption of the latter. T10 Validation Courses have also driven up the total T10 cartridges deployed in-app since April when we released Core II and Gauntlet as well as incorporate the courses into MIS and TIS schools as a part of Training's v24 training booklet. T7 deployments have stayed flat throughout the year, which could be attributed to there not being T7 Validation Courses and/or fewer T7-VR contracts being signed as compared to T10-VR contracts.

vRBT has seen consistent growth in use since its release in December 2024, with significant upticks occurring since the release of Solo mode and Scenario+Playlist customization in April 2025. The only piece of content that has stayed relatively flat has been our two Handgun Range Skills.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT TRAINING (WENMEI HILL)

Through the first half of 2025, CET scenario usage remained steady overall, with June marking the highest single-month total so far this year. While total scenario starts were down approximately 17% compared to the same period in 2024, usage has remained consistent across months, with clear signals that CET content is still serving a critical role in agency training

programs.

Case Law scenarios (*Armstrong v Pinehurst* and *Hyde v Willcox*) continue to see sustained growth, indicating increased agency focus on constitutional literacy and legal decision-making. Officer Wellness content rebounded in Q2 following a slower Q1, and Mental Health scenarios — including *Suicidal Ideation, Schizophrenia, Autism* and *Bipolar Disorder* — remained among the most consistently used. These topic areas all share a common need for emotional realism and human nuance, which reinforces the value of CET's 360° format for high-context, judgment-based training. Crisis response modules like *Traffic Stop* and *Domestic Violence* remain among the most frequently used, supporting routine, operational training at scale.

Several structural factors likely contributed to the modest year-over-year decline. CET is now one part of a broader VR training portfolio, with vRBT, Range Skills, and certification courses offering agencies more immersive options than were available in early 2024. Many CET scenarios are designed for limited replayability and may already be well-used by agencies that onboarded last year. In addition, CET spans multiple categories but includes only a few modules per theme, limiting depth in any one area. Scenario release volume has also dropped by 50% in 2025, reducing opportunities for agencies to refresh their training plans.

Despite these dynamics, CET continues to show reliable usage and content-specific growth in areas where 360 video realism matters most — in particular legal, wellness, and behavioral health — underscoring its role in a balanced VR training ecosystem.

VRBT LIVE ACTION (WENMEI HILL)

Through the first half of 2025, vRBT-LA scenario usage totaled more than 51,000 scenario starts, representing a 64% increase compared to the second half of 2024 (≈31,000 starts). While some seasonal variation is expected in training cadence, the consistent upward trend in usage suggests that vRBT-LA content is gaining traction with agencies as part of their ongoing training cycles, even in the absence of new content releases or formal promotion.

The three most-used scenarios — *Traffic Stop II: Non-Compliant Passenger*, *Terry Stop*, and *Neighbor Altercation* — together accounted for nearly 40% of all usage in H1 2025. These are also the three pre-installed scenarios on the headset, which likely contributes to their higher engagement due to immediate availability during onboarding or demos.

Unlike other VR content, the full vRBT-LA scenario library was released simultaneously in July 2024 and has not expanded since. Despite this, most scenarios have seen flat or increasing engagement over time, with no sharp drop-offs or signs of fatigue. This is a positive sign for long-term value and relevance. Overall, the strong year-over-year growth, broad usage distribution, and consistent engagement across scenarios point to vRBT-LA being a foundational part of agencies' immersive training workflows.

TASER ARENA (ANNE HERMES)

TASER Arena has seen strong adoption across agencies over the past year. with its usage outpacing that of any single SIM Range Skills Module. For example, in April 2025, Arena recorded 3,885 playthroughs compared to 3,399 for the highest-performing SIM module, Moving Targets. Notably, 75% of agencies using SIM in any given month also use Arena, demonstrating its broad appeal as a complementary training option. Usage has steadily increased throughout the past year, peaking at 5,236 playthroughs in July 2025, with agency-level retention rates of ~50% month over month and ~60% quarter over quarter. By 2025 year-to-date, 63% of agencies with a Full VR license have engaged with Arena, reflecting its role as a core training component. Moreover, customers are not only adopting Arena at scale but also engaging deeply. Many choose non-default settings such as the Zombie game environment or the campaign and hardcore modes over the quick 2-minute speed mode, highlighting both the versatility of the platform and the depth of agency investment in using it for meaningful training.

Voice of Customer feedback reinforces this trajectory: interviews with seven of the most engaged agencies highlight TASER Arena's unique role as a high-repetition, stress-inducing, gamified training tool that complements traditional modules. Trainers consistently cited improvements in probe placement, decision-making under pressure, and officer engagement through

scoring and competition. While some agencies noted that a few officers initially treated the experience as “just a game,” trainers reported that competition based on the in-game scoring quickly redirected focus toward accuracy and performance improvement. Agencies also expressed strong interest in features that add environmental complexity, decision-making challenges, and support for competition, underscoring opportunities to expand Arena’s value and sustain its momentum.

HARDWARE USAGE (ZAID ABUGHAZALEH)

Our ArborXR data shows a total of **18,411 enrolled devices** (headsets and tablets).

In the past month, only **22% of headsets** and **~17% of tablets** connected to the internet — approximately **3,564 VR devices** in total. Of these, just **1,024 headsets** received the SIM 2.5.0 update (launched 8/5), indicating that most headsets are still missing the latest features introduced with our new SIM app.

Furthermore, only **3,600 headsets** have received the latest ROM update, leaving about **5,530 headsets** not up to date. Given the Offline Product Usage insights above, it is likely that devices are remaining offline due to infrequent/no use vs extended offline use.

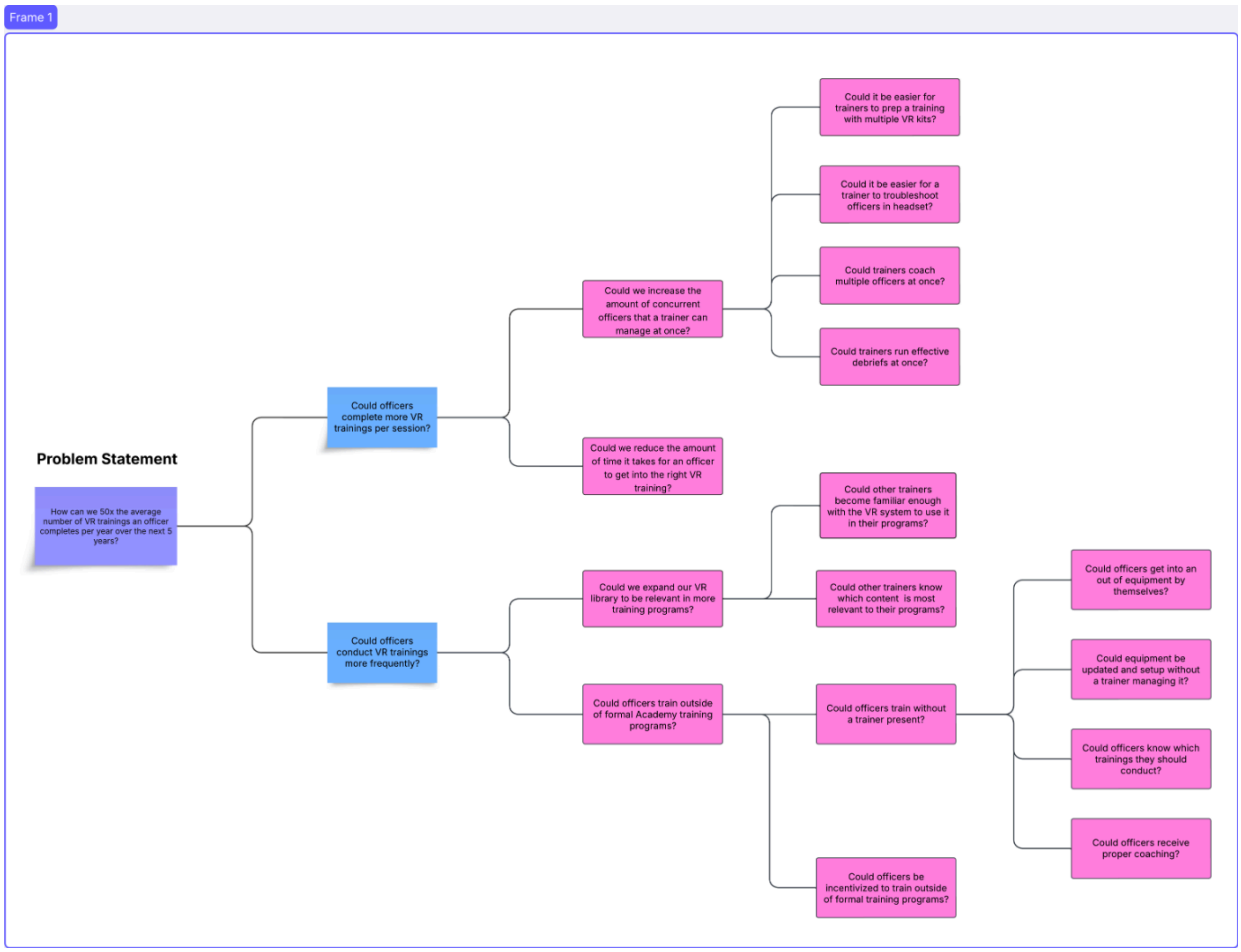
Without stronger connectivity, we face challenges in ensuring device readiness for future deployments and in creating the right environment to support AI-powered and multi-player simulations.

	A	B	C
1	**Universal + Legacy**	**Quantity**	**Percentage**
2	**Total Headsets (Focus3 + Vision)**	9,130	49.60%
3	**Total Tablets (S7 + S9)**	9,281	50.40%
4	**Total Devices (Headsets + Tablets)**	18,411	100%
5			
6	**Online Headsets (2 Months)**	3,153	34.50%
7	**Online Headsets (1 Month)**	2,013	22%
8			
9	**Online Tablets (2 Months)**	3,288	35.40%
10	**Online Tablets (1 Month)**	1,551	16.70%
11			
12	**Online VR Devices (2 Months)**	6,441	35%
13	**Online VR Devices (1 Months)**	3,564	19.40%
14			
15	**Up to date devices (Total)**	2,612	14.20%
16	**Headset with the latet ROM**	3,600	39.40%

Framework to Increase Adoption

We ultimately have two levers at our disposal in order to increase adoption within our products — (1) increase the amount of trainings users complete in their existing VR sessions (ie., annual TASER certifications), and (2) increase the amount of VR sessions users have in a year by expanding VR into other training programs (ie., CIT training programs).

Focusing on those two levers, we can then explore the different challenges we might want/have to solve for in order to increase adoption. The exercise below explores how we might achieve a theoretical goal we have — increasing adoption 50x per user (aka once per week on average) — and what some of those issues might be.



At our Product Offsite in September, we will continue this exercise to identify additional challenges and ideate on possible solutions for each. We will then stack rank the issues by highest impact to adoption, and identified solutions by highest ROI (given LOE to implement) to help inform possible ZBB initiatives for 2026+.

Archive

(Stop Reading)

Project Writeups

PHASE 1 - ANNUAL CEW CERTIFICATION

BUILDING A CURRICULUM

VR Sidekick GPT for Customer-Facing Teams (Jay Silvas) - Static playbooks and scattered resources make it difficult for CSMs to quickly access the latest VR training guidance, product updates, and engagement strategies. This project introduces a dynamic, AI-powered assistant to centralize that knowledge and provide real-time, scenario-based support. By streamlining access to information and templated actions, we aim to enhance ongoing CSM product education/enablement, equip CSMs to provide customized recommendations for agency VR usage, and ultimately increase customer adoption of Axon VR. We are

targeting an initial pilot launch on 8/29, and plan to expand the scope and functionality throughout Q4 to be more evergreen as the product evolves.

FACILITATING A TRAINING

Custom Playlists (Sophi Kim) - Currently trainees have to navigate both HTC and application menus in order to begin an assigned training. In Annual CEW Trainings, these sessions typically happen with multiple officers at once with just one or two trainers available to assist. These officers are also very inexperienced when it comes to VR, and so there are high user-error rates just simply getting into the correct content that a trainer has to rapidly try to triage without any direct visibility into what the officer is doing in headset. When officers have to conduct multiple trainings in a single session — typical in this use case — the error rate compounds. This feature mitigate these issues by putting trainees on “guardrails“ during their training session. It will allow trainers to select and configure a training playlist to persist across all headsets in their agency as they prepare for a training session. Anecdotal feedback from customers estimates that trainees could do 2x the amount of trainings in the same amount of allotted time with this feature alone. Currently in ideation/exploratory phase for a likely 2026 delivery.

PHASE 2 - CEW MICRO-TRAINING

BUILDING A CURRICULUM

Micro-Training Playbook (Chloe Preble) - The goal is to support decentralized and more frequent (micro) training at agencies by providing a one stop shop to address the top pain points and blockers agencies face including:

- Fragmented support across MyAxon, Academy.com, and internal teams
- Gaps in officer-level onboarding that lead to tech confusion and training delays
- Inconsistent implementation and unclear program ownership across agencies
- Lack of trainer workflows for maintaining continuity when roles change
- Limited guidance on communicating with internal stakeholders like IT and agency leadership to ensure buy-in, technical readiness, and program sustainability

We expect the end result to be modular, field-ready guide to help agencies independently implement Axon VR microtraining. It focuses on bringing together best practices for user setup and onboarding through to sustainable training routines, and is designed to scale decentralized VR training through repeatable, field-tested practices. Current draft is under internal review with Training and PSO, and customer testing is planned to confirm tone, usability, and real-world clarity. Currently scoping an Interactive version for 2026 that would support personalization by agency size, training footprint, and tech experience.

SETTING UP A TRAINING

CMS Web UI - Allows trainers to select content that should be downloaded and made available for offline usage. Currently working on foundational CMS 2.0 that will allow for subsequent SKU-CMS and CMS Web UI that will build off of 2.0 work.

FACILITATING A TRAINING

Agency and User-Specific “Sticky” Settings (Sophi Kim) - Allows trainers and trainee’s to configure settings that should be saved across all future sessions, whether at agency or headset-level. Examples include red-dot optics, T7 cartridge loadout. No active work, but slated for 2026 ZBB.

Improving Real-Time Feedback UI to Improve Solo / Micro-Training Outcomes (Lakshmanan Palani) - The Real-Time Feedback System will improve adoption by making solo and micro-training more intuitive, engaging, and effective. Instead of overwhelming users with cluttered or confusing cues, the new system delivers clear, prioritized, and consistent feedback that helps officers understand and correct their performance in the moment. This reduces cognitive overload, builds confidence for self-directed training, and enables scalable use in kiosks without constant trainer support . Phased-Out improvements,

including ambient voice + light cues for instructions, clearer hit indicators, synchronized visual/audio threat cues, a persistent hierarchical UI, and dummy-anchored feedback panels. These updates not only improve the immediate user experience but also lay the foundation for AI-enabled coaching, and consumable AAR.
Real Time Feedback System: One Pager

DOCUMENTING A TRAINING

User Identification in Headset (Sophi Kim) - Prior to this feature, the only mechanism for users to have their results recorded to their personal accounts was to pair with a trainer on a tablet. This meant that for an agency to log any SIM training data, they would have to train in a 1:1 setting with trainers, which is not much of a possibility outside of remedial training given time and resource limitations. This feature now enables trainees to “self-identify” on headset through a personalized QR code. Completing SIM exercises after sign-in will record student’s activity in the Web App AAR repository. This feature is currently available in SIM (as of 8/5/25) and we are actively working to expand into other app’s.

PHASE 3 - OTHER IN-SERVICE TRAININGS

BUILDING A CURRICULUM

VR Content Selection GPT (Wenmei Hill / Emilee Daley) - As our VR library expands across CET, vRBT-LA, and Simulator, internal teams and trainers are struggling to quickly identify modules that align with specific training goals. To solve this, we built a GPT-powered content assistant trained on structured Axon VR content — including facilitator guides, scenario scripts, learning objectives, and metadata schemas — that returns relevant modules based on learning goals, topics, or free-form queries. Full internal launch to CSM and PSO teams is targeted for 8/30/25, and a future customer-facing version is under consideration based on internal usage and feedback.

Scaling VR Instructor Training Beyond PSO Deployments (Christian Kardish) - As Axon VR continues to expand in scope, complexity, and training relevance, our current training model—where agency trainers receive hands-on instruction only once during PSO deployment—is becoming unsustainable. Trainers are expected to support a rapidly evolving product with no recurring formal enablement, making re-engagement difficult, especially for infrequent users. This challenge is compounded by overreliance on TASER instructors and the risk of program stagnation when key trainers leave. To ensure long-term success and adoption across an agency’s full contract term, we must scale PSO-style enablement in new ways, such as virtual check-ins, integration with existing training infrastructure, or dedicated VR certification programs. One pager exploring possible solutions: One Pager: Scaling Product Onboarding Across the Contract Lifecycle.